Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Saturday, 17 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Light drizzle	Overcast	Mostly clear	Clear
14° 8°	12° 7°	12° 5°	11° 4°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **A woman has told a court she was left 'bewildered and confused' by an alleged sexual assault involving Russell Brand.**

The 51-year-old comedian and actor is facing three counts of rape, three of sexual assault, and one of indecent assault. He denies all the charges. The trial continues.

CRIME · UK

2 **A nurse has been jailed for stealing £750,000 from a 99-year-old woman to fund cosmetic surgery and home improvements.**

Rebecca Louise Burwood had formed a close bond with the vulnerable victim, even referring to her as her 'nanna'. The court heard she exploited the woman's trust for her own lavish lifestyle.

CRIME · UK

3 **Prime Minister Andy Burnham has invited Scotland's First Minister John Swinney to work together on 'deeper Scottish devolution'.**

On his first major trip to Scotland since becoming PM, Mr Burnham urged politicians to focus on practical solutions. He said the time has come to move beyond the issue of Scottish independence.

POLITICS · UK

4 **A police officer who raped two women has been jailed for 12 years, following a series of physical and sexual abuses.**

Campbell Petrie was found guilty of the offences, which took place between 2006 and 2022. The court heard harrowing details of the abuse suffered by his victims.

CRIME · UK

5 **A dad has been fined after his two-year-old son died in a fall from a Cyprus hotel window.**

Joshua Foster reportedly 'lost control' of his son while showing him the view of a water park. The tragic incident occurred during a family holiday.

TRAGEDY · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Marvel fans, get ready to meet a new Welsh superhero, complete with a Cardiff accent, in the upcoming Disney+ series!**

Lauren Morais will play the villain Lisa Molinari in 'VisionQuest', a new superhero series. It's fantastic to see more regional accents making their way into the Marvel universe!

ON AIR — What other regional accents would you love to hear in a big superhero franchise?

TV · COMING UP

2 **The acclaimed police drama 'Blue Lights' is returning, highlighting the tensions between police and communities in Northern Ireland.**

The award-winning series has resonated deeply with audiences for its realistic portrayal of policing. It's great to see a drama tackling such important and often complex issues.

ON AIR — Are you looking forward to the return of 'Blue Lights'? What do you think makes it such a compelling watch?

TV · COMING UP

3 **Robert Pattinson stars in a new film, 'Primetime', exploring how hunting predators became hit TV.**

Pattinson portrays the real-life host of the American TV show 'To Catch a Predator' in his latest role. It sounds like a fascinating, and potentially unsettling, look at a controversial form of entertainment.

ON AIR — What are your thoughts on shows like 'To Catch a Predator'? Do you think they serve a public good or are they problematic?

FILM · COMING UP

4 **The new 'Street Fighter' movie is being touted as 'made by fans for fans', hoping to deliver a knockout blow to critics!**

Cast members Noah Centineo, Andrew Koji, and Callina Liang have been discussing the latest video game adaptation. Video game movies can be a mixed bag, so let's hope this one hits all the right buttons!

ON AIR — Are you a fan of video game adaptations? What's your favourite, or one you're really looking forward to?

FILM · COMING UP

5 **Slipknot fans are hitting back after Marilyn Manson was announced as a support act for their upcoming UK show.**

The heavy metal band will be joined by the controversial US rock musician during their London gig. It's certainly sparked a lot of debate among their fanbase!

ON AIR — How much does a support act influence whether you'd go to a concert? Does it ever put you off?

MUSIC · COMING UP

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Manchester City face 'substantial hurdles' in their appeal against breaking the Premier League's financial rules.**

A leading lawyer has told BBC Sport that the club will find it tough to overturn the guilty verdict. This saga looks set to run for a while longer!

ON AIR — Do you think Manchester City will successfully appeal, or is this a done deal for them?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Great Britain's Mark Stewart and Anna Morris have added to the gold medal tally at the Track Cycling World Championships in Shanghai.**

Stewart won gold in a thrilling points race, while Morris secured gold in the women's omnium. Fantastic news for British cycling on the world stage!

ON AIR — Are you following the Track Cycling World Championships? What's been your highlight so far?

CYCLING · UK

3 **The Scottish Premiership is set for a big weekend, with a Celtic-Hearts showdown topping the bill on Sunday.**

Before that, there are five other intriguing matches scheduled for Saturday. It promises to be a crucial few days in the Scottish football calendar.

ON AIR — Who do you think will come out on top in the Celtic-Hearts clash? Any predictions for the other games?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Chelsea captain Reece James is set to miss three months of action after undergoing knee surgery.**

This is a significant blow for the Blues, who will be without their influential defender for a crucial period. Injuries are really starting to pile up for some teams this season.

ON AIR — How big a loss is Reece James for Chelsea? Will they be able to cope without him?

FOOTBALL · UK

5 **England captain George Williams says his side will relish their 'underdog' tag against a powerful Tonga side in their World Cup opener.**

The Rugby League World Cup kicks off in Perth, and England are ready for the challenge. It's always exciting to see how the 'underdogs' perform on the big stage!

ON AIR — Do you think England can cause an upset against Tonga, or are they truly the underdogs here?

RUGBY LEAGUE · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1. **A new study suggests that keeping houseplants can significantly boost your mood and productivity.**
   Researchers found that even a single desk plant can reduce stress levels and increase focus, turning any workspace into a mini-oasis.

2. **The joy of 'upcycling' old items into something new is sweeping the nation.**
   From old jam jars becoming elegant candle holders to worn-out denim turning into quirky bags, people are loving the creative challenge and sustainable aspect.

3. **The simple pleasure of 'watching birds at a garden feeder' is becoming a widespread mindful moment.**
   Many are finding that taking a few minutes to observe the local feathered friends brings a surprising sense of calm and connection to nature.

4. **A trend for 'home-made bread-making' has seen a massive resurgence.**
   The comforting aroma and the satisfaction of pulling a warm, crusty loaf from the oven are proving to be irresistible for many.

5. **The delightful discovery of 'a forgotten fiver in an old coat pocket' remains a universal small joy.**
   It's like a tiny, unexpected bonus from your past self, making an ordinary day feel a little bit special.

6. **More people are embracing the 'art of perfectly packing a picnic basket' for impromptu outdoor meals.**
   It's all about clever layering, reusable containers, and making sure the sandwiches don't get squashed – a true skill!

7. **The satisfying feeling of 'organising a kitchen drawer' has been highlighted as a surprisingly therapeutic activity.**
   Taking the time to arrange cutlery, utensils, or spices into neat order brings a small but significant sense of accomplishment.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of cheese will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?**

ANSWER: GIVING IT A LITTLE SNIFF — YOU KNOW, A SUBTLE, ALMOST IMPERCEPTIBLE SNIFF, AS IF YOU'RE JUST CASUALLY EXAMINING THE PACKAGING!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd ritual' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a new box of tea bags, especially if they're a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: LIFTING THE LID AND TAKING A DEEP, APPRECIATIVE INHALE OF THE AROMA — ALMOST LIKE IT'S A FINE WINE!

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those little 'everyday sounds' that, for some reason, just fill us with a quiet sense of satisfaction or happiness.**
  What's that one sound for you? Is it the gentle sizzle of butter in a pan, the soft rustle of leaves on a breezy day, or perhaps the familiar 'thunk' of the post landing on the doormat?

- **There's something wonderfully nostalgic about 'traditional British sweet shops' and their colourful displays of sugary delights.**
  What's the one classic sweet or treat that instantly takes you back to your childhood, and why was it your absolute favourite?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** On Venus, a day is longer than a year. It takes Venus about 243 Earth days to rotate once on its axis, but only about 225 Earth days to orbit the Sun.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts on the International Space Station can only drink recycled water that has been filtered through a complex system made entirely from plant fibres.

Prepflow

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£3.4 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.4 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The inventor of the frisbee was cremated and had his ashes incorporated into frisbees.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The world's smallest chameleon, the Brookesia micra, is so tiny it can sit on the head of a match.
- Before erasers were invented, people used breadcrumbs to rub out pencil marks.
- The 'king' of a deck of cards is the only one without a moustache.
- The average cloud weighs around 550 tons, roughly the same as 100 elephants.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth and can be seen from space.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES SAT 17 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 290 of the year, 75 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anstrudis; Christian feast day: Catervus; Christian feast day: Ethelred and Ethelberht; Christian feast day: Florentius of Orange. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1969 — Wood Harris, American actor
- 1966 — Mark Gatiss, English actor, screenwriter and novelist
- 1974 — Matthew Macfadyen, English actor
- 1960 — Guy Henry, English actor
- 1941 — Paul Ellison, American musician
- 1980 — Angel Parker, American actress
- 1971 — Derrick Plourde, American drummer (died 2005)
- 1948 — Margot Kidder, Canadian-American actress (died 2018)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1965 — The 1964–65 New York World's Fair closes after two years and more than 51 million attendees.
- 2004 — A fire that lasted over 15 hours destroyed almost one third of the East Tower of the Parque Central Urban Complex in Caracas, Venezuela.
- 1991 — Rudrapur bombings by Sikh separatists, who explode two bombs, during a Ramlila Hindu celebration in Rudrapur, Uttarakhand, killing 41 people.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1989 — The East German Politburo votes to remove Erich Honecker from his role as General Secretary.
- 1977 — The hijacked Lufthansa Flight 181 lands in Mogadishu. The remaining hostages are later rescued.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1969 — The Caravaggio painting Nativity with St. Francis and St. Lawrence is stolen from the Oratory of Saint Lawrence in Palermo.
- 1994 — Russian journalist Dmitry Kholodov is assassinated while investigating corruption in the armed forces.

- 2019 — Drug dealers in Culiacan, Sinaloa, Mexico force the government to back down on an arrest.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES SUN 18 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 291 of the year, 74 days left in 2026. Today Alaska Day (Alaska, United States); Christian feast day: Asclepiades of Antioch; Christian feast day: Isaac Jogues; Christian feast day: Luke the Evangelist. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1982 — Mark Sampson, Welsh footballer and manager
- 1967 — Eric Stuart, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and voice actor
- 1961 — Gladstone Small, Barbadian-English cricketer
- 1947 — Joe Morton, American actor
- 1929 — Hillard Elkins, American producer and manager (died 2010)
- 1935 — Peter Boyle, American actor (died 2006)
- 1989 — Joy Lauren, American actress, director, and producer
- 1965 — Curtis Stigers, American singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1979 — The Federal Communications Commission (FCC) begins allowing people to have home satellite earth stations without a federal government license.
- 1914 — The Schoenstatt Apostolic Movement is founded in Germany.
- 1929 — The Judicial Committee of the Privy Council overrules the Supreme Court of Canada in Edwards v. Canada when it declares that women are considered "Persons" under Canadian law.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

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10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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